PassFrame
TUITION

The Locked Door in the Orchard Wall

Year 5 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Fiction

Extract — read it carefully before answering

Eleanor had lived at Thornfield Hall for three weeks before she discovered the wall. It ran along the far edge of the orchard, half-swallowed by ivy, its old red bricks crumbling gently in the autumn light. She might never have noticed it at all, had a robin not perched on top of it one morning and seemed, quite deliberately, to be waiting for her.

She followed the wall for almost a hundred paces before she found it: a door, so completely covered in dead ivy that it looked more like a tangle of roots than anything built by human hands. The handle was rusted nearly solid, and a heavy padlock hung from a chain, its keyhole clogged with years of dirt.

Eleanor pressed her eye to a gap where the wood had split. Beyond, she could just make out a garden gone entirely wild — rose bushes grown as tall as trees, grass standing in golden waves, and, at the very centre, a stone fountain, silent and dry, its basin filled with drifted leaves.

Nobody at Thornfield Hall had ever mentioned a garden behind the orchard wall. When Eleanor asked the old gardener, Mr Hodge, his face changed in a way she could not quite name, and he told her sharply to keep away from that corner of the grounds.

But that night, lying awake and listening to the wind rattling the windowpanes, Eleanor could think of nothing else. Somewhere beyond that locked door was a garden that time itself seemed to have forgotten — and she was quite determined to find a way in.

Questions

20 min · 12 questions

1. How long had Eleanor lived at Thornfield Hall before she found the wall?

2. What creature seemed to be waiting for Eleanor on top of the wall?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you the door was almost completely hidden.

4. Underline 2 similes in the extract.

5. What does “deliberately” mean in the sentence about the robin?

6. True or false: Mr Hodge was happy to talk to Eleanor about the hidden garden.

7. Why do you think Mr Hodge's “face changed in a way she could not quite name”?

8. What three things could Eleanor see through the gap in the door?

9. In your own words, describe the state of the garden Eleanor glimpsed.

10. What does the phrase “a garden that time itself seemed to have forgotten” suggest about the garden?

11. Why do you think nobody at Thornfield Hall had mentioned this garden before?

12. What do you predict Eleanor will do next? Use evidence from the text to support your answer.